

Tech Throwback @2024

As we gear up to dive into the tech trends set to define 2025, I can't help but reflect on the remarkable year we're leaving behind. I'll admit, I started the year as something of an AI skeptic. The hype seemed overblown, and I wasn't convinced it would make a tangible difference in our daily lives anytime soon. But as the months rolled by, I found myself increasingly intrigued. So much so that I decided to dive deeper. I enrolled in a formal certification course at the Indian School of Business (ISB) that focuses on AI and its impact on businesses and organizations. This journey transformed me from a skeptic to an enthusiast, opening my eyes to the incredible potential AI holds for the future.

Big Tech found itself under more scrutiny than ever, facing questions about monopolies and ethics. Industries from semiconductors to automobiles experienced seismic shifts that kept us all on our toes. So, as we look forward to what 2025 has in store, let's take a moment to revisit the trends that dominated and defined 2024. Here's a look back at what ruled in 2024.

AI's move from hype to reality

Exactly around this time last year, as I prepared to visit CES 2024, I predicted that AI would dominate marketing narratives with little substance or real-world impact. Fast forward 12 months, and I stand corrected. For me, the most groundbreaking development has been AI's strides toward logical reasoning. OpenAI led the charge with the introduction of reasoning models.

AI Agents emerged as another game-changer towards the end of 2024. Microsoft's announcement of its AI Agents initiative underscored a bold move toward redefining productivity. However, the meteoric rise of AI in 2024 wasn't without controversy. The ethical implications of AI came under intense scrutiny. The issue of AI systems exacerbating misinformation and the lack of transparency in AI model training added urgency to calls for stronger regulatory frameworks. As we bid goodbye to 2024, it's clear that AI has entered an era of both immense opportunity and heightened responsibility. It's no longer just about automation; AI is now reshaping how we think, work, and create—while challenging us to address the ethical questions.



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Editor-in-Chief



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ARM's Challenge to x86 Dominance

The semiconductor industry has experienced a notable shift, with ARM-based processors gaining significant traction against the traditional x86 architecture dominated by Intel. ARM's energy-efficient designs have appealed to a broad range of applications, from mobile devices to personal computers. Analysts predict that ARM-based system-on-chips could capture up to 30% of the PC market by 2026, signaling a substantial challenge to x86's long standing supremacy.

Computers on wheels? No, please!

In 2024, the automotive sector increasingly leaned on technological features to capture consumer interest, often prioritizing advanced infotainment systems, connectivity options, and semi-autonomous driving capabilities over traditional vehicle performance. While tech in cars undeniably brings advancements in safety and security, I personally find the overuse of technology—sometimes for the sake of it—more distracting than delightful. Touchscreens are replacing tactile buttons, colorful MIDIs are taking over from classic analogue rev meters, and cars are starting to resemble rolling computers rather than driving machines. This obsession with tech often results in features that feel half-baked or unnecessary. Give me a sweet-sounding, peppy engine, a smooth-shifting transmission, and a car with tight, responsive handling over a tech-stuffed gadget on wheels any day. But, I must admit, I might just be in the minority here!

The year of digital scams

In 2024, cyber fraud in India surged dramatically, with losses reaching approximately ₹11,333 crore in just the first nine months—a staggering 113.7% increase in daily cybercrime complaints compared to 2022-2023. The scary reality is that advanced tech based on AI and deep fakes often seem to have the upper hand in terms of impact, posing a sobering question: could technology become more of a destroyer than a healer? It harks back to the early days of the internet, when cybercrime was an unchecked industry thriving on its ability to outpace regulation.

Did I miss any trends? Write to me and share your list. I'd love to take a look! **d**